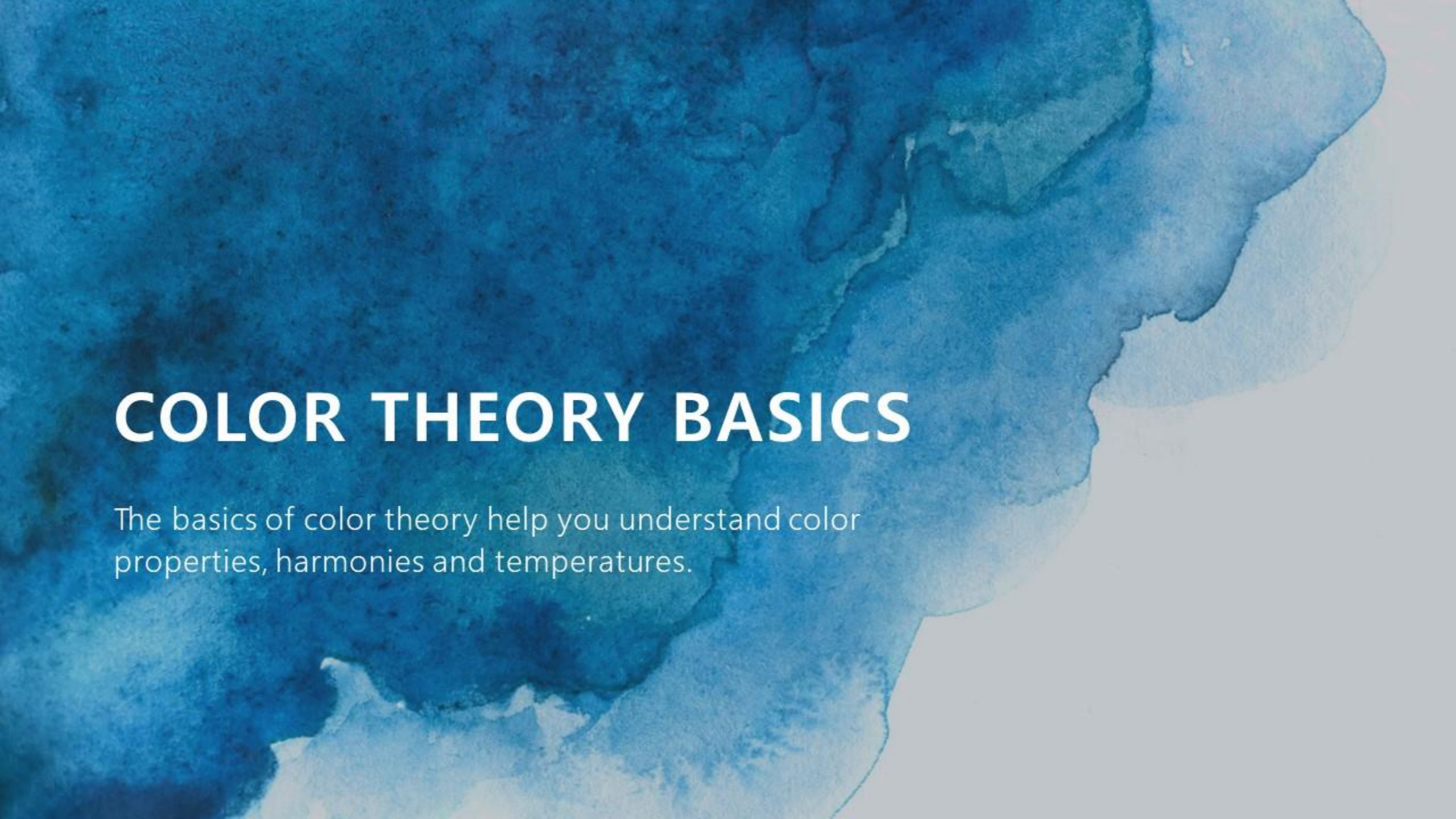


The background of the slide is an abstract watercolor wash in various shades of blue, ranging from deep navy to light sky blue. The paint strokes are visible, creating a textured, organic feel. The darker blue area occupies the left and top portions, while the lighter blue washes out towards the right and bottom.

COLOR THEORY BASICS

The basics of color theory help you understand color properties, harmonies and temperatures.

Color Wheel

- One of the best tools for understanding color basics is the color wheel. It helps you see the relationships between individual colors in order to use them appropriately. The color wheel organizes pigment, which is used to produce color in illustration, art and printing.

Color Wheel

- It includes twelve colors based on Isaac Newton's visible color spectrum, and is organized into three categories: primary colors, secondary colors and tertiary/intermediate colors. Understanding these relationships is essential to using color in your designs.

Color Wheel

- Primary Colors (red, yellow, blue) are referred to as primary because no other colors can be mixed to create them.
- Secondary Colors (green, orange, violet) are formed from combining two primary colors.
- Tertiary Colors (red-orange, red-violet, yellow-green, yellow-orange) are created when a primary and a secondary color are mixed.

Color Properties

- Color has three primary qualities, known as properties: hue, value and intensity. Each property affects the way we perceive color. Understanding these concepts will help you create and effectively apply color palettes in your designs.

Color Properties

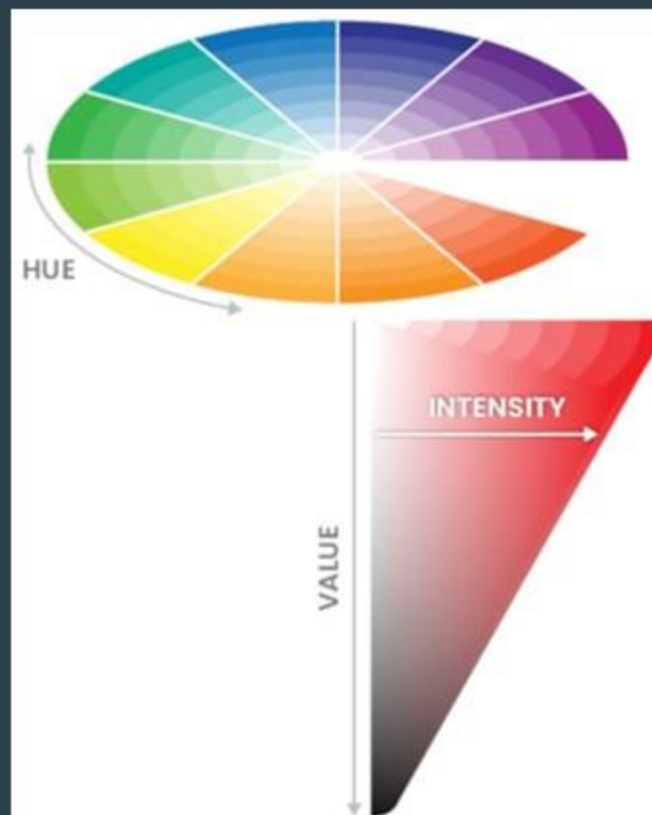
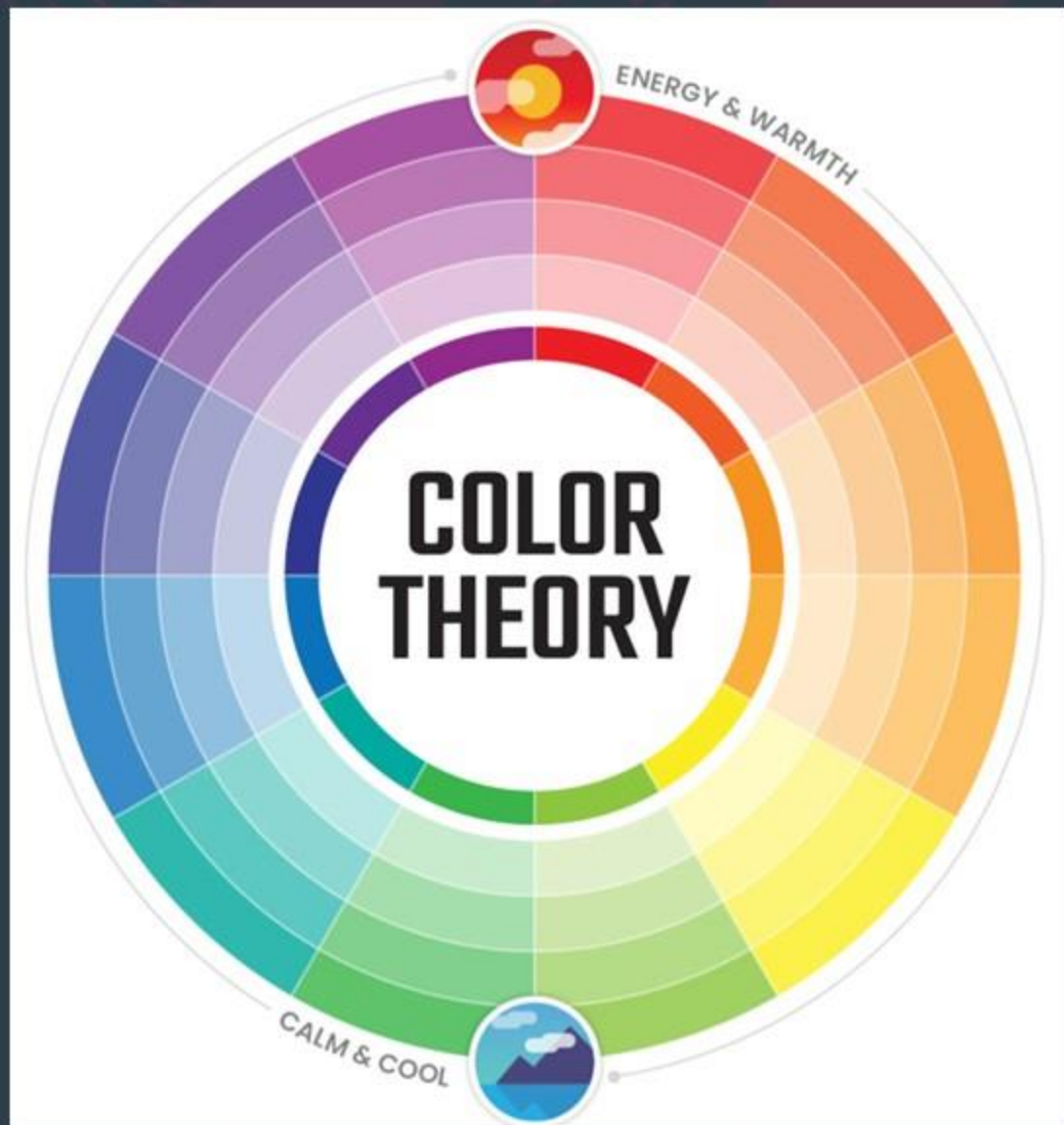
- Hue refers to a color in its pure state. It also denotes a color's position on the color wheel.
- Value describes the degree of lightness or darkness in color. There are three ways to change the value of a color: *tinting* lightens the color by adding white, *toning* softens a color by adding gray and *shading* darkens a color by adding black.
- Intensity is the brightness or dullness of a color based on saturation. A color is most intense in its purest form (hue). Intensity is low when a color is mixed with a complementary color or a neutral color.

Color Harmony

- Color harmonies are a way of using color to create visual interest. These color schemes go well together to create a sense of order and organization.
 - **Monochromatic** uses different tones, shades and tints of one color.
 - **Analogous** uses colors that are next to each other on the color wheel.
 - **Complementary** uses colors that are opposite each other on the wheel.
 - **Split Complementary** uses the colors on either side of the complement.
 - **Triadic** uses three colors that are equally spaced on the color wheel, forming a triangle.
 - **Tetrad** uses two complementary pairs, forming a rectangle on the wheel.

Color Temperature

- Color has the power to evoke emotions. Color temperature describes the warmth or coolness of a color. Warm colors, such as red, yellow and orange, evoke energy and warmth because they are associated with things like the sun or fire. Cool colors, such as blue, green and purple, evoke a relaxed and calming feeling because they remind people of things like water or grass.



HUE

This refers to a color in its pure state. It also denotes a color's position on the color wheel.



INTENSITY

The brightness or dullness of a color based on saturation.



VALUE

This describes the degree of lightness or darkness in color.



TINT = White + Hue



TONE = Gray + Hue



SHADE = Black + Hue

HARMONIES

Color schemes are patterns that go well together and help create a sense of order.

MONOCHROMATIC



ANALOGOUS



COMPLEMENTARY



SPLIT COMPLEMENTARY



TRIAD



TETRAD



The background of the image is an abstract watercolor wash in various shades of blue, ranging from deep navy to light sky blue. The paint strokes are visible, creating a textured, organic feel. The text is overlaid on the darker blue portion of the wash.

COMPOSITION TECHNIQUES TO CREATE ENGAGING IMAGERY

- 
- The header features a dark blue background with a series of overlapping, semi-circular geometric patterns in a lighter blue shade. These patterns include concentric circles, radial lines, and dotted lines, creating a modern, abstract design.
- Understanding composition and how to use the variety of composition techniques will help you move beyond just “taking a picture” to creating impactful images. Capturing an impactful image takes planning. Although much of the planning process is internal, being aware of the basic composition techniques and using them effectively can significantly improve the quality of your imagery.

- 
- The top of the slide features a decorative header with a dark blue background. It contains several overlapping semi-circular shapes. Some of these shapes are filled with a lighter blue color, while others are filled with a pattern of small, light blue dots or lines, creating a textured effect.
- Let's explore basic composition techniques such as the center of interest, framing, balance and the rule of thirds; and using creative elements in compositions, including shapes, lines, patterns and textures; balance and perspective.

Basic Composition

- Center of Interest
- Rule of Thirds
- Golden Mean
- Framing

Center of Interest

- A photo should contain only one center of interest. This will help arrest attention and the viewer will not be confused about the message you are trying to convey. Whenever you plan a photograph, look long and hard at the subject until you are aware of every single aspect and detail. Then analyze what you see. Ask yourself these questions:
 - What's the strongest point of interest?
 - How can I make this feature prominent?
 - Which other elements support the main feature, and where should they be placed to balance or add drama to the picture as a whole?

Center of Interest

- Once you have a clear idea of what the main element should be, start thinking about how you can give prominence to this feature and make sure other details in the scene do not compete for attention.
- Three ways to ensure you have one center of interest:
 1. **Frame in the viewfinder** - Frame the subject in the viewfinder to eliminate distracting elements from the photo.
 2. **Contrast** - Use tonal or color contrasts between the subject and surrounding areas.
 3. **Selective Focus**- Use depth of field to isolate the main subject by making the background out of focus.



In this photo, the strongest point of interest is in the center. Depth of field is utilized to give context, but doesn't take away from the main subject.

Rule of Thirds

- The main subject should occupy a strong position in the frame. One way to do that is to employ the “rule of thirds.” Divide the frame into 9 equal rectangles, 3 across and 3 down. Imagine a tic-tac-toe board overlaid on the viewfinder.

Rule of Thirds

- The idea of the rule of thirds is to place the important element(s) of the scene along one or more of the lines, or where the lines intersect, with the subject looking in the direction of the empty space that remains. Although you may want to place the subject squarely in the middle, the photo is more interesting when you place the subject along one of the intersections.

Rule of Thirds

- The rule of thirds is not a guarantee to good composition, but it can keep you from making disastrous mistakes, including putting your subject too close to the edge.
- Many camera manufacturers have the capability to display the rule of third grid in the viewfinder.

Rule of Thirds



In this photo, the main subjects and action points are not directly in center, which gives the photo more energy.

Golden Mean

- The “golden mean” or “golden ratio” is a great way to create aesthetic proportions in your photographs. This classical rule is similar to the rule of thirds, but it places the subject slightly closer to the center, and helps you avoid imbalance in your images.
- The grid below is referred to as the “Phi Grid” which consists of squares and a spiral that looks like a snail’s shell. Use the squares to help position the elements in the image. The spiral acts like a leading line that gives the viewer a sense of how the image flows.

Golden Mean



- In this photo, notice the subject positioning guides your eye up and around and back into the image.

- 
- The header features a dark teal background with a series of overlapping, semi-circular patterns. These patterns are composed of concentric lines and dots, creating a sense of depth and movement. The colors are muted, with shades of purple and blue.
- Composition plays a vital role in a photographer's ability to capture imagery accurately. Learn how the golden ratio and the rule of thirds can help make you a better photographer.

- [Video](#)

Framing

- Frames give your photographs depth. You can use man-made elements, such as arches or windows, to act as frames around your main subject, or use natural elements found in your scene such as trees.

Framing

- Use the technique of creating “frames within a frame” to:
 - draw attention to the main subject
 - hide unwanted details in a scene
 - add contrasting tones or colors into what could be a flat or monochromatic scene
 - get creative with your surroundings and add depth to your images
- When deciding to use a frame, ask yourself:
 - Does this frame complement the main subject?
 - Does it add relevant information?
 - Is there a valid reason for using the frame?

If you answer no to all those questions, you should avoid using framing and use another composition technique.

Framing



- In this photo, a frame overlay has been added to call attention to the main subjects

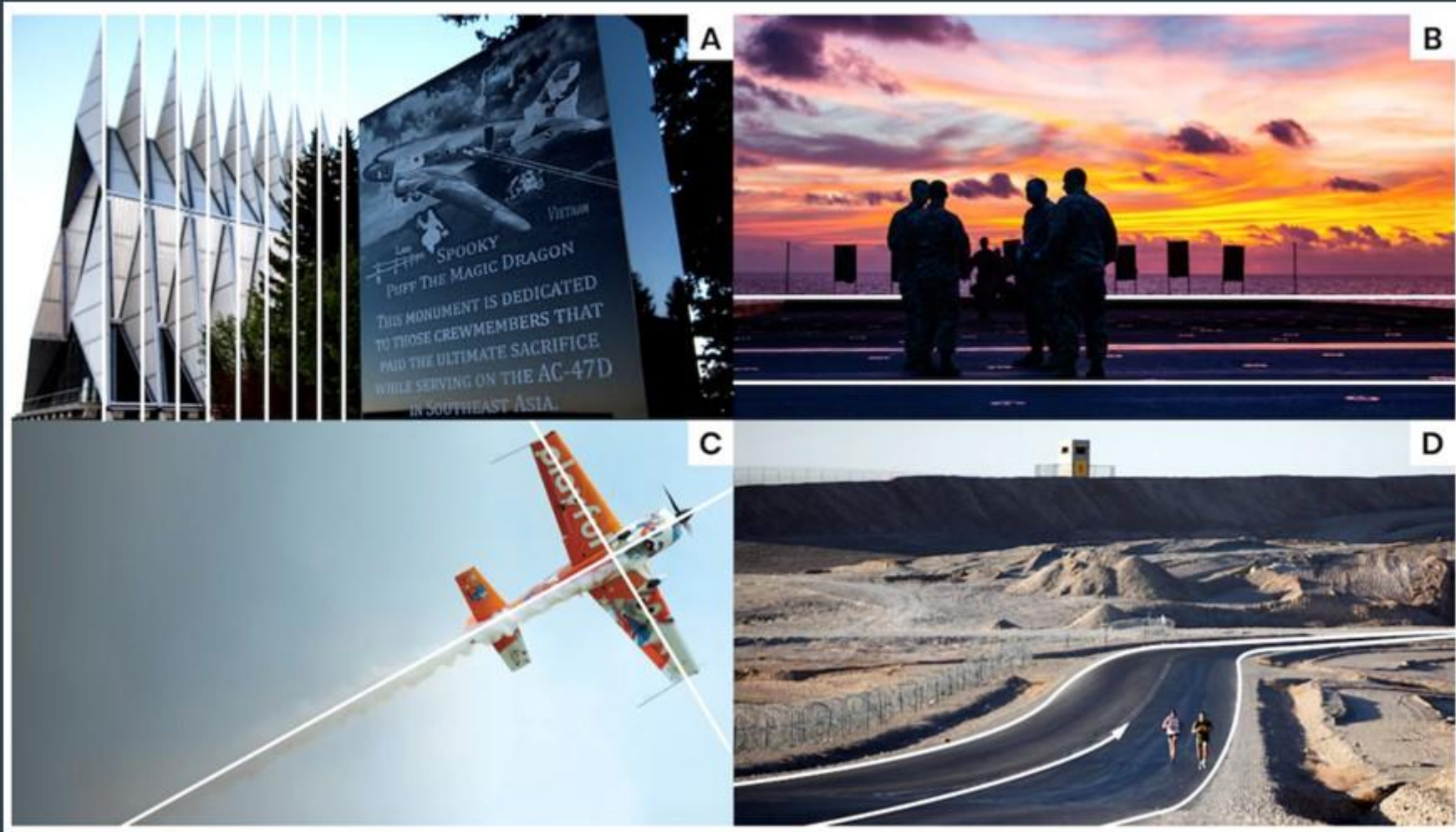
Creative Elements

- Lines
- Shapes
- Patterns & Textures

Lines

- Lines in your photographs can create different feelings. For example, **vertical lines** create height and give a sense of strength. **Horizontal lines** create stability, and create a sense of peace and tranquility. **Diagonal lines** create a sense of speed, motion or instability. **Curved lines** create a sense of grace. Understanding the effect that different types of lines create will help you add a depth and dimension to your photographs.

Lines



- In this photo, notice how the lines; vertical, horizontal, diagonal and curved, evoke different feelings. Each can be used to the photographer's advantage to enhance the story.

Lines

- **Leading lines** draw the eye to the main subject of the photograph and focus attention on important elements. You can find leading lines in objects such as walls, walkways or patterns. Keep in mind, however, that not every line in an image is a leading line.

Lines



- In this photo, the angle of the shot guides the eye along the entire line of divers.

Shapes

- While horizontal and vertical lines create stability in images, incorporating diagonals and shapes like triangles into your images create dynamic tension. You should look for actual triangles that appear in your scenes, but you can also imply triangles by how you position elements in your scenes. Leading lines can be placed on a diagonal to form triangles that all meet at a single point, which should be the center of interest.



- In this photo, multiple diagonals and triangles in this photo create tension and drama.

Patterns & Textures

- People are attracted to patterns, especially when patterns appear as a kind of geometric construction. Patterns can create a sense of harmony in a photograph.

Two types of pattern effects:

1. Informal patterns
2. Geometric patterns

Two Types of Pattern Effects

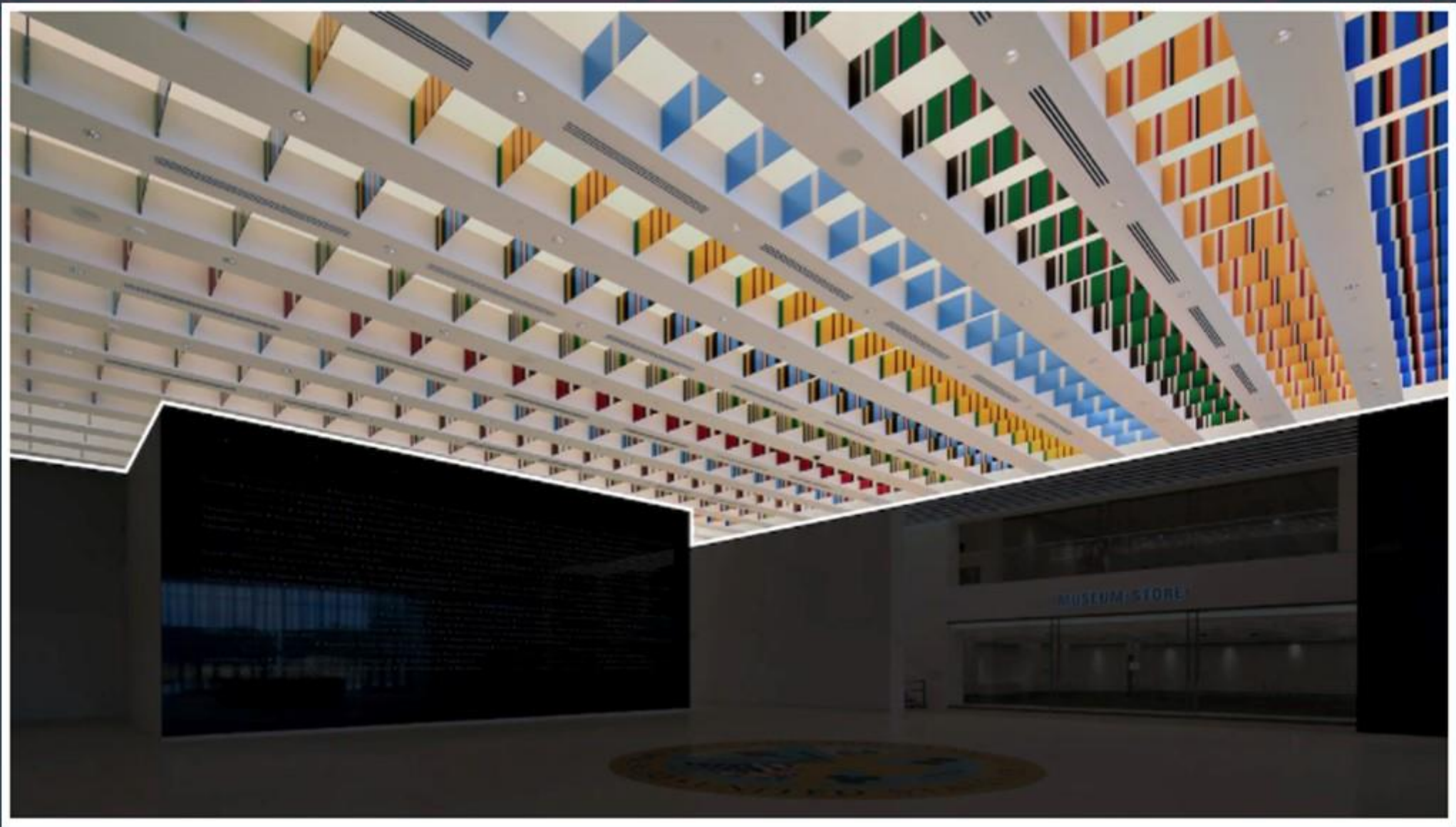
- Informal patterns are used for decoration and can be used to add dimensions to an image, breaking up the flatness and dullness of the background or foreground. Think of items you see in nature that tend to not be symmetrical - such as leaves, rocks and mountains. Using informal patterns gives a feeling of freedom and unpredictability.



- The angle of the photo, the colorful climbing grips, even the way the subject's hair is braided all add to the joy and movement of the composition.

Two Types of Pattern Effects

- Geometric patterns occur when figures in a scene are distributed geometrically, such as arranging figures of a photograph into the vertices of a triangle. They can show up as circles, squares, rectangles, polygons, etc... Geometric patterns tend to be symmetrical. To emphasize these patterns, shoot straight on at right angles to the surface. Black-and-white and monochrome images will highlight the shapes and patterns more clearly. If you shoot down along the surface, you can create a sense of depth, because the patterns will change in shape as they recede into the distance.



- Notice how the ceiling, which mimics uniform ribbons, presents a number of geometric patterns.

Textures

- Textures also create visual interest and depth in your photographs. People are attracted to them because they convey both visual and tactile sensations. With the right lighting, you can pick out rugged surfaces in sharp textual relief or reveal fine texture in surfaces that seem almost completely smooth to the eye.
- To bring out the texture of an object, the light should come from an oblique angle so that it rakes the subject's surface, highlighting each small relief and creating shadows within the indentations.



- This photo is so texturally rich, you can almost feel the flour on your hands.

Balance

- Formal or Symmetrical Balance
- Informal or Asymmetrical Balance

Formal or Symmetrical Balance

- While the rule of thirds and the golden mean encourage you not to place subjects in the center of the frame, if situations arise where symmetry is naturally occurring, this is a perfect time to create a formal or symmetrically balanced image.

Formal or Symmetrical Balance

- Formal or symmetrical balance occurs when elements of a similar size and shape on both sides of a photograph are of equal visual weight. Each element contributes to the composition but no one area overpowers another. While images with formal balance can look static and unexciting, they are aesthetically pleasing and present a sense of stability, formality and dignity. Architecture, roads, bridges and scenes where reflections are visible are excellent candidates to use this composition technique.



- In this photo, a powerful lifter is showcased beautifully in black and white, with strong lighting to show off the physical symmetry.

Informal or Asymmetrical Balance

- Informal or asymmetrical balance occurs when two or more elements in a photograph are of different size and shape, but still visually balance out the areas within the frame. Asymmetric balance occurs when the perceived visual weight of two or more lighter objects is evened out by a single, heavier object placed on the opposite side of the image.
- Typically, asymmetrical balance is visually more interesting than symmetrical balance.



- In this photo, both the helicopter and the yellow shirt airman are equally weighted in the frame.

Perspective

- Photographic Perspective
- Linear Perspective
- Dwindling Size Perspective

Photographic Perspective

- Perspective in photography refers to the sense of depth or spatial relationships between objects in the photo, as well as with their size and shape, with respect to the camera lens or the viewer. Since photography is a two-dimensional art, perspective is the most important composition technique to help extend the image into the third dimension.

Photographic Perspective

- A lot of photos are taken at eye level, but one simple way to achieve drastically different looks is to change your point of view. Get high up and shoot down on the subject, or get down low and shoot up at the subject to create a more interesting image.



- The top down angle of this shot adds much more to the composition than a straight on photo.

Linear Perspective

- Linear perspective is achieved by capturing parallel lines that converge in the distance. Creating linear perspective will often produce a stronger sense of depth and distance than other visual elements in a photograph, especially when a photograph is composed so that the converging lines lead a path straight away from the camera.



- In this photo, the converging lines in this photo add depth and drama to this photo.

Dwindling size Perspective

- Dwindling size perspective is achieved when objects farther from the camera appear smaller than objects that are closer to the camera. This composition is effective at creating a sense of depth in an image.



- Even though all of these headstones are identical in size in this photo, the angle at which they are shot makes some appear smaller.

The background of the image is an abstract watercolor wash in various shades of blue, ranging from deep navy to light sky blue. The paint strokes are visible, creating a textured, organic feel. The blue area occupies the left and center, while the right side fades into a plain white background.

DESIGN CONCEPTS FOR STANDOUT VISUALS

- 
- The header features a dark teal background with a series of overlapping, semi-circular geometric patterns in a lighter teal color. These patterns include concentric lines, dotted arcs, and solid arcs, creating a modern, abstract design.
- Design is the process of developing a plan for a visual product using visual language to communicate ideas, concepts and messages to a specific audience. Layout is the arrangement of text, images and/or graphics.

- 
- A decorative border at the top of the slide featuring a repeating pattern of semi-circles and concentric arcs in a dark teal color.
- A successful design connects the viewer and the message. Composition, Components and Content, known as the Three Cs of Layout, are fundamental concepts to achieve successful designs that result in effective layouts.

Composition

- Composition is the way the components of a layout are visually combined and arranged. Ask these questions to determine the position of the elements in a layout:
 - What is the product and how will it be presented?
 - Is the message you are trying to communicate evident to the user?
 - Have I demonstrated the principles of design - balance, rhythm, unity, emphasis and contrast?

Components

- Components are the visual elements used within a design. Examples of components include photos, illustrations, icons, typography, lines, decorations, borders and backgrounds. Choice and placement of the elements should be considered in relation to the total composition. Keep these text guidelines in mind:

Components

- Text
 - Legible: Ensure you can make out all the letters.
 - Readable: Copy should flow naturally and make sense. Poor text hierarchy can ruin a good layout.
 - Size and space: Font should be spaced and sized appropriately for the product and message.

Components

- Imagery
 - Cropping: Use the cropping tool to zero in on the message.
 - Color: Adjust the color within the image elements to establish visual interest, create a focal point or add variety.
- Color and Value
 - Unify: Use color and value to bring your design together and create a theme.
 - Energize: Bold decisions around color can add tension— when needed— to produce a more vibrant layout.

Components

- Design Choices
 - Connotation: Each element communicates a meaning and style, which should tie into the layout's overall theme, support the layout's purpose and help communicate the intended message.
 - Attributes: Text, imagery, color and all other possible elements should create balance, rhythm, unity and emphasis.
 - Placement: Elements either serve as a focal point or a support for the main idea.

Concept

- Concept is the theme or style of design (based on the purpose of the product) used to reinforce the message and appeal to the target audience. These intangible ingredients of a design are critical to its visual presentation and delivery of the message.
 - Clarity: Simplify the work to create the biggest visual impact.
 - Unity: Remove competing elements that can muddy the message for a unified theme.
 - Purpose: Know your purpose so your viewer doesn't misinterpret your meaning.
 - Audience: Tailor the text and images to the target audience.

LAYOUT AND DESIGN PRINCIPLES

CONCEPT

The theme or style of the design should communicate the message, be clear, simple and appeal to the target audience.



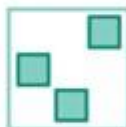
COMPOSITION

How all the components are combined and arranged to compose the layout.



Message

Organize and place components to communicate the purpose.



Balance

How weight and negative space set the mood and visual path.



Rhythm

Patterns create movement to communicate the mood and readability.



Unity

Group a variety of elements together to give the layout flavor.



Emphasis

What stands out and gets noticed first.



Symmetric



Asymmetric



Optical Center



Golden Mean



Rule of Thirds



Information Hierarchy



Focal Point



Size



Boldness

COMPONENTS

Create visual elements that work together to create a total composition.



Text

Should be legible, readable and use fonts that align with the message.



Lines

Create rhythm or direct attention. Organize, group and separate information.



Shapes

Anything with a height and width, including space, can be used to communicate.



Imagery

Illustrations and photographs set a tone through visuals, color and cropping.

When designing components consider their:



Alignment



Color



Contrast



Spacing



Size



Visual Hierarchy



Texture

Layout Design and Principle

CONCEPT

The theme or style of the design should communicate the message, be clear, simple and appeal to the target audience.



Layout Design and Principle

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Symmetric



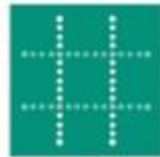
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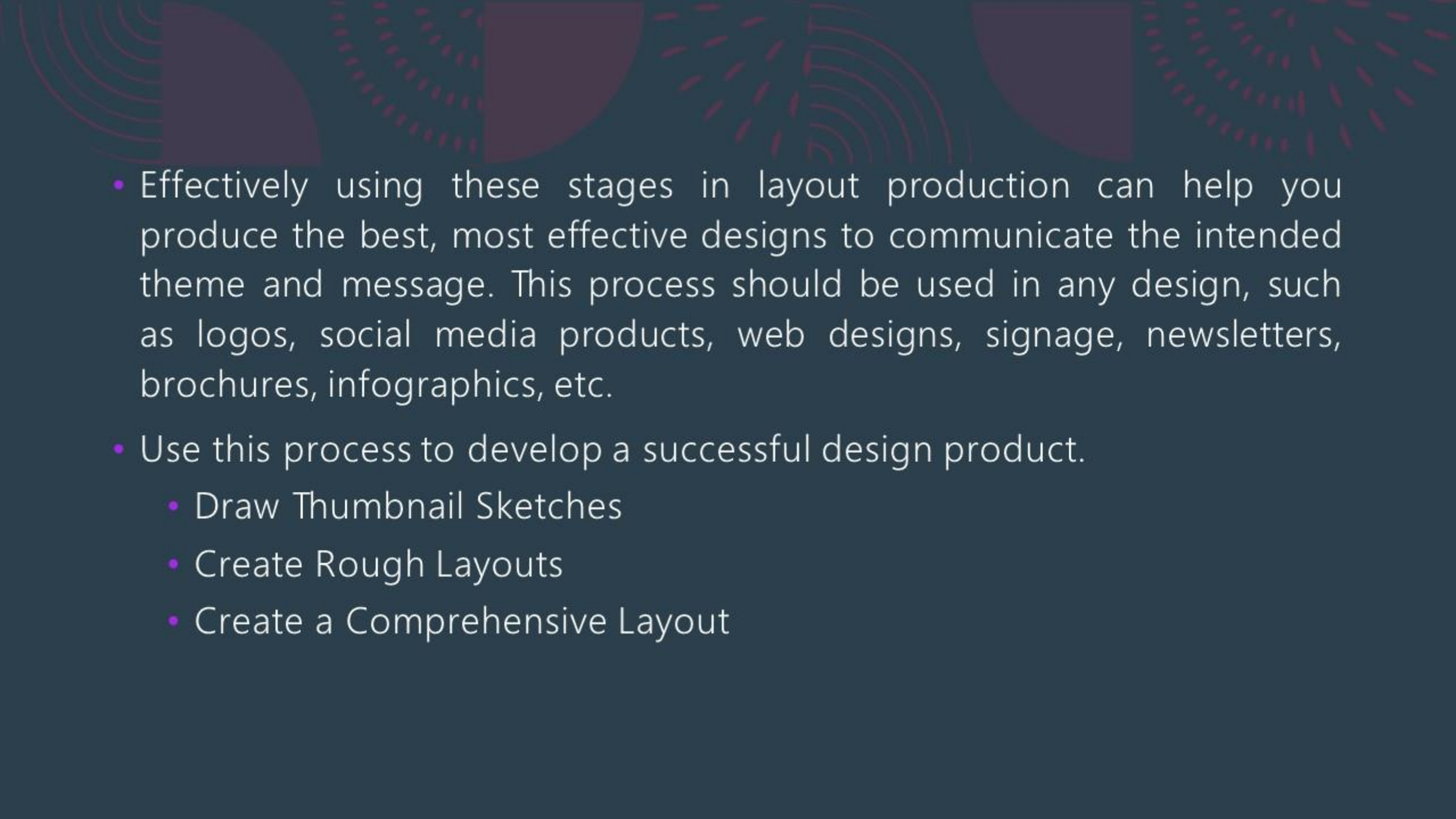
Texture

The background of the slide is a blue watercolor wash. It features a dark, textured blue on the left side that fades into a lighter, more transparent blue towards the right. The edges of the color are soft and irregular, characteristic of watercolor painting. The overall effect is a calm, artistic backdrop for the text.

HOW TO PRODUCE A LAYOUT IN GRAPHIC DESIGN

Review these steps to develop a successful layout.

- 
- Layout is a significant part of graphic design. A layout is the way design elements are arranged on a page. The design progresses through different stages during development - a designer uses thumbnail sketches, rough layouts and comprehensives during the design process - from the development of an idea to producing a final product. The product idea evolves with the designer's creativity and the client's input.

- 
- Effectively using these stages in layout production can help you produce the best, most effective designs to communicate the intended theme and message. This process should be used in any design, such as logos, social media products, web designs, signage, newsletters, brochures, infographics, etc.
 - Use this process to develop a successful design product.
 - Draw Thumbnail Sketches
 - Create Rough Layouts
 - Create a Comprehensive Layout

Draw Thumbnail Sketches

- Thumbnail sketches are rough sketches that get your ideas on paper in different arrangements.
 - Sketch your design ideas quickly.
 - Put down as many as possible.
 - Don't discard any ideas - sometimes the best ideas are a combination of ideas.
 - Thumbnails are much smaller than the final product size, but should be in general proportion to the finished size.
 - The whole point of these sketches is to generate visually appealing ideas. Text is only a placeholder, so it does not need to be legible.



- A rough sketch should carve out space for all the details you'll want to include in your final drawing, but is mostly made up of placeholders.

Create Rough Layouts

- Rough layouts, also called roughs, are black and white sketches that present a more accurate visual of the proposed design.
- Get feedback and direction from the customer before going to the next step.
 - Roughs come from the best thumbnail ideas - sometimes they are a combination of the elements in several thumbnails.
 - Sketch roughs in full detail, but without the color. The idea should not depend on color to communicate the message.
 - Refine the elements of the composition. Decide details such as font, type size, style and other information.
 - Repeat the process until a design idea has been selected and approved. Then proceed to the next step.
 - Roughs are worked up in the same proportion and about half the size as the finished product.



- The final rough sketch comes from the best ideas and may contain elements from several thumbnails.

Create a Comprehensive Layout

- The comprehensive layout, also called a comp, is a prototype of the final layout.
 - Shows how the final product will look when it is finished.
 - Includes all details: specific colors, images/art, as well as display and body type.
 - Sketches of images and artwork are replaced by the actual files.
 - At this stage, any changes are usually very minor before the design is finally approved.



- The final design is a comprehensive layout and incorporates the most-up-to-date feedback . Sketches and placeholders have been replaced with final images and copy.



Thank you.